

ASCENTIS LEVEL I READING TEXT TYPES, PURPOSES AND FEATURES

AIMS:

Identify different text types

Identify the purposes of different texts

Identify text features

TEXT TYPES

- **Possible exam question**
What kind of text is this?
- **Possible answers**
- Advertisement, review, letter, email, newspaper article, magazine article, information leaflet, biography, book review, webpage, recipe, directions, set of instructions, story (fiction or non-fiction), biography, etc.

TEXT FEATURES

- Different texts have different features or characteristics.
- **Possible exam questions**
Give one text feature which suggests that it is a newspaper article.
- *Which text feature suggests that this is a webpage?*
- **Task**
- Look at the newspaper article and webpage on the following slides. How do you know it is a newspaper article or web page?

NEWSPAPER ARTICLE

What are the features of this newspaper article?

- Headline
- Subheading
- Byline (author's details)
- Photograph
- Columns

New tabloid size
With two pull-out sections

Journal Fear and loathing at the BBC + Bernie Sanders + Polly Toynbee + What is gene editing?

G2 #MeToo creator Tarana Burke + Rhik Samadder + Scott Walker

Sport Thrilling Liverpool end Man City run → Back pages

Monday
15 January 2018
Issue N° 53,506
www.theguardian.com
£2.00 | £2.50



The Guardian

Students drafted in to plug NHS gaps

Exclusive Safety concerns as undergraduates volunteer on short-staffed wards and A&E

Sarah Marsh
Denis Campbell

Medical students are being urged to help relieve the NHS winter crisis because hospitals are so short-staffed they are struggling to cope with the surge in patients, the Guardian can reveal. Despite their lack of experience, undergraduates are being asked to volunteer in A&E units and on wards reeling under the weight of extra demand caused by the cold weather, an outbreak of flu and people suffering serious breathing problems. They have been told to expect to fit cannulae - tubes inserted so patients can receive medication - take blood and run errands, all work usually done by healthcare assistants or ward clerks. The British Medical Association said that asking students who had not qualified in medicine to assist with, in some cases, severely ill patients was "a desperate measure" that could put patients at risk and exploit undergraduates who agreed to help. The disclosure also led to warnings that hospitals could face legal difficulties if students made mistakes and concern that their presence on wards could disguise the depth of NHS understaffing. Medical schools are asking fourth- and fifth-year students for urgent assistance at "hard-pressed" nearby hospitals and GP surgeries, according to emails obtained by the Guardian. Dr Andrew Hassell, head of Keele University's medical school, wrote to students recently to enlist support in tackling the NHS's "national crisis". "We're sure you don't need us to tell you about the extraordinary situation the whole of the NHS is facing this winter," wrote Hassell, who is also a senior figure at the NHS trust that runs hospitals in Stoke and Stafford. "As the medical school for this area we think we should be doing whatever we can to support local services while maintaining student learning. We are sure you will want to be part of our collective effort at this time of national crisis," he said in the email, sent last week. He added that he had already contacted the medical director (most senior doctor) at his own trust and at the Shrewsbury and Telford Hospital NHS Trust "to ask them to let us know if there's anything we can do to help". Hassell told students: "Do volunteer to help in any way possible, providing it's within your competence. This applies to students in hospitals and in GP [general practice]". On 4 January, two days after the seriousness of the winter crisis led NHS bosses to

Carillion talks fail to provide rescue plan

Rob Davies

The construction firm Carillion was on the brink of collapse last night, raising fears for the future of a number of large-scale government projects and day-to-day services, from schools to hospitals, prisons and the army. The Cabinet Office hosted emergency talks aimed at mapping out a future for a company that employs 43,000 people - including nearly 20,000 in Britain - but the meeting broke up without a rescue deal. The accountancy firm EY has been drafted in to manage a potential administration process, which could be triggered this morning. Labour called for a public inquiry into the rapid decline of a company, whose chairman is an adviser to the prime minister Theresa May on corporate responsibility. Trade unions branded Carillion a "textbook example of the failures of privatisation", and urged the government to step in to guarantee jobs and services. Opposition MPs are expected to question the government today on why it awarded Carillion lucrative public sector contracts, including £1.4bn



Chelsea Manning reveals plan to run for US Senate

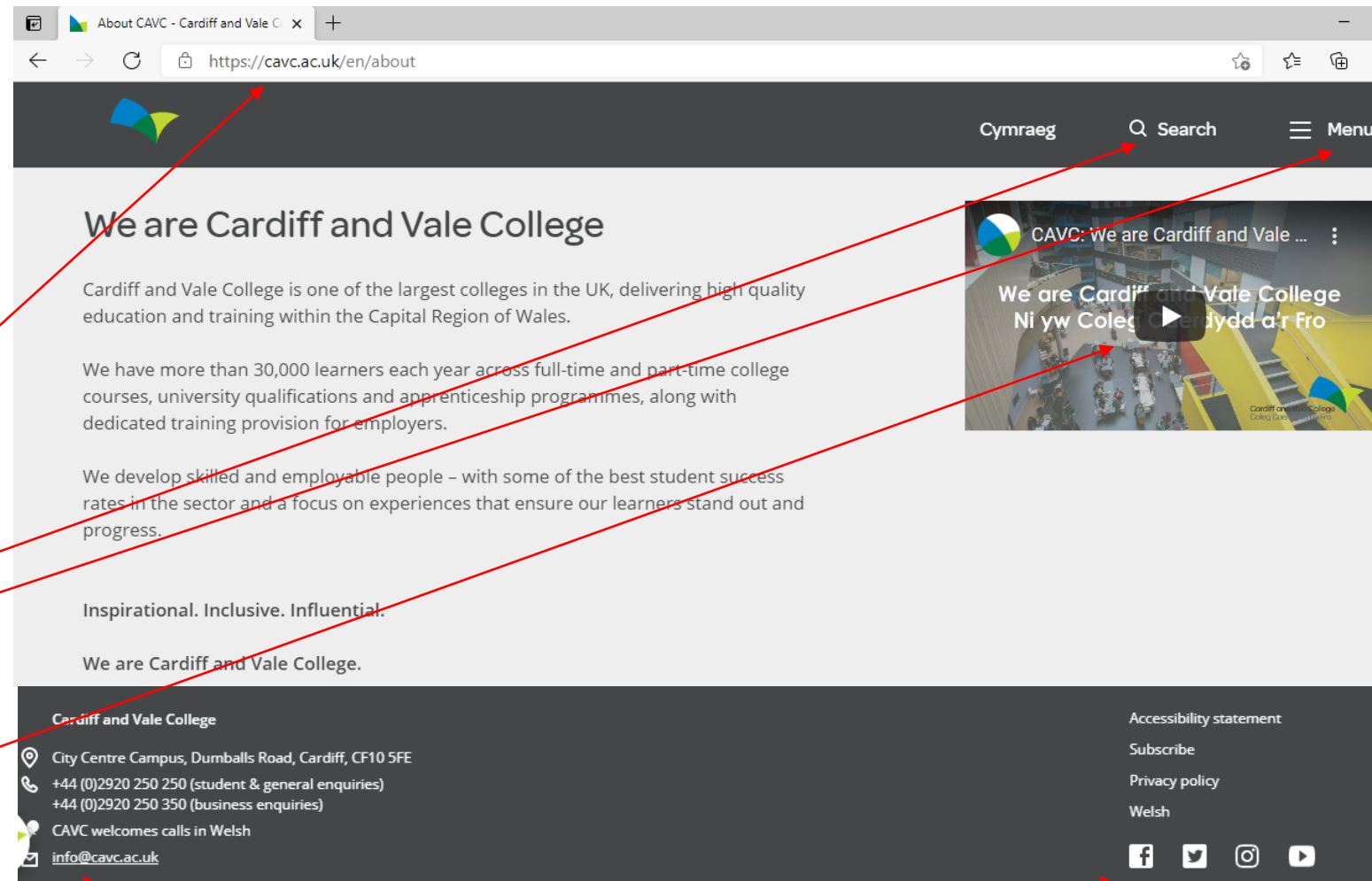
The whistleblower, who spent seven years in a military prison, has posted a video on Twitter announcing her intention to run in this year's US Democratic primaries, saying: "We live in trying times. Times of fear, of suppression, of hate ... We don't need more or better leaders, we need someone willing to fight."

▲ Chelsea Manning in her video revealing her political ambitions
PHOTOGRAPH: YOUTUBE

WEBSITE

What are the features of this website?

- Web address
- Search bar
- Menu
- Embedded video
- Hyperlinks



TEXT PURPOSES

- Different texts are written for different reasons. They have different *purposes*.
- **Possible exam questions**
- *What is the main purpose of this text? a. to persuade b. to inform c. to instruct d. debate*
- *What type of text is this? a. persuasive b. informative c. instructive d. discursive*
- **Tasks**
- Look at the table on the next slide. Match the purposes with their definitions and the type of text they might relate to.

TEXT PURPOSES TASK I

- Match the purposes with their definitions and the type of text they might relate to:

PURPOSE (V / ADJ / N)	DEFINITION	TEXT TYPE(S)
To entertain / entertaining / entertainment	a. Gives opinions for and against	1. Novel, story
To inform / informative / information	b. Helps people decide what to do	2. Science article
To warn / warning	c. Gives the pros, cons and a recommendation	3. Health and safety sign
To debate / to discuss / discursive	d. Tells a reader about the facts of something	4. Advantages / disadvantages article
To advise / advising / advice	e. Makes the reader enjoy reading	5. NHS web page about treating an illness
To review / reviewing / review	f. Tells you to be careful about something	6. Film or book critique

TEXT PURPOSES TASK I ANSWERS

- Match the purposes with their definitions and the type of text they might relate to:

PURPOSE (V / ADJ / N)	DEFINITION	TEXT TYPE(S)
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To inform / informative / information	b. Helps people decide what to do	2. Science article
To warn / warning	c. Gives the pros, cons and a recommendation	3. Health and safety sign
To debate / to discuss / discursive	d. Tells a reader about the facts of something	4. Advantages / disadvantages article
To advise / advising / advice	e. Makes the reader enjoy reading	5. NHS web page about treating an illness
To review / reviewing / review	f. Tells you to be careful about something	6. Film or book critique

TEXT PURPOSES TASK 2

- Match the purposes with their definitions and the type of text they might relate to:

PURPOSE (V / ADJ / N)	DEFINITION	TEXT TYPE(S)
To describe / descriptive / description	a. Tries to sell you a product or an event	1. Political campaign poster
To persuade / persuasive / persuasion	b. Gives details about a person, place, thing	2. Letter of complaint
To instruct / instructive / instructions	c. Tells you the disadvantages or problems	3. Events promotion leaflet
To advertise / advertising / advert(isement)	d. Tries to change a reader's opinion	4. User-guide
To criticise / critical / criticism	e. Tells a reader how to do something	5. Travel guide

TEXT PURPOSES TASK 2 ANSWERS

- Match the purposes with their definitions and the type of text they might relate to:

PURPOSE (V / ADJ / N)	DEFINITION	TEXT TYPE(S)
To describe / descriptive / description	a. Tries to sell you a product or an event	1. Political campaign poster
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To instruct / instructive / instructions	c. Tells you the disadvantages or problems	3. Events promotion leaflet
To advertise / advertising / advert(isement)	d. Tries to change a reader's opinion	4. User-guide
To criticise / critical / criticism	e. Tells a reader how to do something	5. Travel guide

TEXT PURPOSES REFERENCE

PURPOSE (V / ADJ / N)	DEFINITION	TEXT TYPE(S)
To entertain / entertaining / entertainment	Makes the reader enjoy reading	Novel, story
To inform / informative / information	Tells a reader about the facts of something	Science article
To warn / warning	Tells you to be careful about something	Health and safety sign
To debate / to discuss / discursive	Gives opinions for and against	Pros and cons article
To advise / advising / advice	Helps people decide what to do	NHS web page about treating an illness
To review / reviewing / review	Gives the pros, cons and a recommendation	Film or book critique
To describe / descriptive / description	Gives details about a person, place, thing	Travel guide
To persuade / persuasive / persuasion	Tries to change a reader's opinion	Political campaign poster
To instruct / instructive / instructions	Tells a reader how to do something	User-guide
To advertise / advertising / advert(isement)	Tries to sell you a product or an event	Events promotion leaflet
To criticise / critical / criticism	Tells you the disadvantages or problems	Letter of complaint

TEXT PURPOSES QUIZ

For a quiz to test your understanding of text purposes, look here:

- <https://downloads.bbc.co.uk/skillswise/english/en03text/quiz/en03text-11-quiz.pdf>

LANGUAGE FEATURES

- **Possible exam questions**
- 1. Which of these language features show that the text contains instructions?
 - *a. past tense b. complex sentences c. imperatives d. questions*
- 2. The paragraph headings are in question form. This is because:
 - *a. the writer doesn't know the answer.*
 - *b. it helps the reader find the answers.*
 - *c. it makes the text more serious.*
 - *d. it is testing the reader's knowledge.*

LANGUAGE FEATURES TASK

- Match the language features underlined in the sentences with the correct terminology in the box:

Reported speech	comparative and superlative	passive voice	modal verb	relative
clause	imperative	narrative tenses	conditional	contraction
				personal pronoun

1. Do it now! **Imperative**
2. America was discovered by Christopher Columbus. **Passive voice**
3. He's coming tomorrow. **Contraction**
4. They should have the vaccine. **Modal verb**
5. If I were rich, I'd buy a new car. **Conditional**
6. You could try this new recipe. **Personal pronoun**
7. Wales, which is a small country, is situated in the south-west of the UK. **Relative clause**
8. They told us that we needed to arrive early for the exam. **Reported speech**
9. When I woke up, the sun was shining and my family had already eaten breakfast. **Narrative tenses**
10. Birmingham is bigger than Cardiff but London is the biggest. **Comparative and superlative**

Why are these language features used? Discuss in groups.

LANGUAGE FEATURES REFERENCE

TERMINOLOGY	EXAMPLE	USE(S)
Imperative	<u>Do</u> it now!	Instructions and orders
Passive voice	America <u>was discovered</u> by Christopher Columbus.	To make writing more impersonal / formal. When we do not know the 'doer' of an action or it's not important.
Contraction	He <u>s</u> coming tomorrow.	Informal writing.
Modal verb	They <u>should</u> have the vaccine	To show attitudes. 'Should' is used for advice / suggestions.
Conditional	<u>If I were rich, I'd buy</u> a new car.	To describe possibilities or unreal or hypothetical things.
Personal pronoun	<u>You</u> could try this new recipe.	'You' is used to speak directly to the reader.
Relative clause	Wales, <u>which is a small country</u> , is situated in the south-west of the UK.	To define something / someone or give additional information about something or someone.
Reported speech	<u>They told us that we needed to arrive early for the exam.</u>	To report the words that someone used.
Narrative tenses	When I <u>woke</u> up, the sun <u>was shining</u> and my family <u>had</u> already <u>eaten</u> breakfast.	To tell stories in the past.
Comparative / superlative	Birmingham is <u>bigger than</u> Cardiff but London is <u>the biggest</u> .	To compare people or things.

PUNCTUATION AND OTHER TEXT FEATURES

Possible exam questions

1. The writer uses ● bullet points in the text. This is because:
 - a. it makes information hard to read
 - b. it makes the text look more serious
 - c. it makes key information easy to find
 - d. it makes the text look more fun
- 2. The last sentence has some words underlined. This is because it:
 - a. gives a warning.
 - b. contains a hyperlink.
 - c. shows the writer's opinion.
 - d. helps the writer to remember.
- 3. The last sentence is in **bold** in order to:
 - a. show that it's reported speech.
 - b. show the writer's opinion.
 - c. show that it's a quote.
 - d. emphasise it.

QUIZ

- Now, to test your knowledge of punctuation and other text features, do this WORDWALL quiz:
- <https://wordwall.net/play/14608/777/116>

USEFUL WEBSITES

- For further practice, take a look at the BBC skillswise web pages here:
- Reading: text types
<https://www.bbc.co.uk/teach/skillswise/types-of-texts/z7g9f4j>
- Sentence grammar: Punctuation
<https://www.bbc.co.uk/teach/skillswise/punctuation/z7b247h>